SF SystemForge

BONUS GUIDE · 7-DAY PLAN

# Money Reset *in 7 days*

A calm, step-by-step week to take control of your money. Use it with your Budget Planner.


01 Your 7-day plan

02 Pick a budget style

03 Pay off debt faster

04 Build a safety cushion

05 Printable budget worksheet


Not financial advice: a simple method to organize your own money. Adjust it to your life.

# 01 Your 7-day plan

ONE SMALL STEP A DAY

| | |
|---|---|
| DAY 1 | **Find your real income**<br>Add your paychecks for one month in Transactions. Use what lands in your bank, after tax. |
| DAY 2 | **List every bill**<br>Add rent, phone, internet, insurance and every subscription in Bills & subscriptions with its due day. |
| DAY 3 | **Look at last month**<br>Add last month's spending in Transactions. Don't judge it, just see it. |
| DAY 4 | **Set your categories**<br>Give each category a Monthly budget. Start with needs, then savings, then wants. |
| DAY 5 | **List your debts**<br>Add each debt in Debt payoff with its balance, interest rate and minimum payment. |
| DAY 6 | **Pick one savings goal**<br>Start small: a $500 safety cushion. Add it in Savings goals with a deadline. |
| DAY 7 | **Plan your weekly check**<br>Pick a day (Sunday works well) for a 5-minute look at your Status column. |

# 02 Pick a budget style

THERE IS NO PERFECT BUDGET

SIMPLE

### 50 / 30 / 20

Split your income after tax into three groups.

1. About 50% for needs
2. About 30% for wants
3. About 20% for savings and debt

Best if you want a quick start and fewer numbers.

DETAILED

### Every dollar has a job

Plan every dollar before the month starts.

1. Write your income
2. Give each category an amount
3. Keep going until $0 is left to plan

Best if money feels tight and you want full control.

**EXAMPLE** With $3,000 a month after tax, 50/30/20 gives about $1,500 for needs, $900 for wants and $600 for savings and debt.

**TIP** Rent is high where you live? Try 60/20/20. The best budget is the one you can keep.

# 03 Pay off debt faster

TWO METHODS THAT WORK

SAVES THE MOST INTEREST

## Avalanche

1. Pay the minimum on every debt
2. Put every extra dollar on the highest interest rate
3. When it's gone, move to the next highest

FEELS GOOD FAST

## Snowball

1. Pay the minimum on every debt
2. Put every extra dollar on the smallest balance
3. When it's gone, roll its payment into the next one

### How the template helps

Your Debt payoff table sorts by interest rate (avalanche order). Type an **Extra payment** and the **Payoff** column shows how many months are left and your debt-free month.

NOTE Interest rates and terms differ. Check your real numbers with your lender.

YOUR SAFETY CUSHION

# 04 Build an emergency fund

1. **Start with $500**
   A small cushion stops a flat tire from becoming new debt.

2. **Then one month of needs**
   Add up rent, food, bills and transport for one month. That's your next goal.

3. **Then three months**
   Three months of needs gives you room to breathe if something big happens.

4. **Keep it separate**
   Use a different savings account so you don't spend it by accident.

5. **Automate it**
   Move a fixed amount on payday, even $25. Update Saved in your Savings goals.

> **Pay yourself first: move money to savings on payday, before you spend.**

# 05 Budget worksheet

FOR YOUR MONTHLY MONEY DATE

Month: _____ Income after tax: $ _____

| CATEGORY | PLANNED | SPENT | LEFT |
|---|---|---|---|
| 🏠 Rent / mortgage | | | |
| 🛒 Groceries | | | |
| 💡 Bills & utilities | | | |
| 🚌 Transport | | | |
| 🛡️ Insurance | | | |
| 🍽️ Eating out | | | |
| 🛍️ Shopping | | | |
| 📺 Subscriptions | | | |
| 🎉 Fun | | | |
| 💰 Savings | | | |
| 📉 Extra debt payment | | | |
| Total | | | |

**One thing I'll do differently this month**